Anything for You

By Cathy Celesia

At Rise: *LYNETTE sits alone at a table for two, staring into her drink. GAIL approaches the table, a bit harried. She kisses the preoccupied LYNETTE on the cheek, sits.*

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS 1: *You've been best friends forever. You vacation together. . .*
ACTRESS 2: *You were in each other's weddings; your husbands are best friends too.*
ACTRESS 2: *Lynnette and Gail are the best of friends . . . Friends who can share* ***anything!***
ACTRESS 1: *But times and people change and so do relationships.*
ACTRESS 2: *So regardless of how awkward the conversation. It's friends who will do*
TOGETHER: *Anything for You by Cathy Celesia*

GAIL: **(Pgs 13-20)** Sorry I'm late. I was just about to walk out when this rap artist of ours plops himself in the outer office, announces he's not leaving until somebody acknowledges his artistic crisis. This is a kid, nineteen years old mind you, who has a house in the Hamptons and a hot tub for every day of the week, and he's having an artistic crisis. That needs acknowledgment. *(She picks up a menu.)* Have you ordered yet? *(perusing the menu)* So I have to sit there for twenty minutes trying to sound sincere when I tell him "It's not so bad, Roger. Money doesn't compromise your art. It just makes it more affordable." When what I really wanted to say was, This is the legal department. We work here. You're feeling screwed up or dysfunctional, go to artistic, bother them. So anyway. . . the squab looks good. What do you think? *(GAIL continues to study the menu. LYNETTE leans forward in her chair.)*

LYNETTE: I need to have an affair.

GAIL: Hmm? Did you say something?

LYNETTE: I said, Gail, that I need to have an affair.

GAIL: *(looking up)* You don't mean that.

LYNETTE: Yes I do.

GAIL: An affair?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

LYNETTE: Yes.

GAIL: You?

LYNETTE: Uh-huh.

GAIL: But you and Richard

LYNETTE: I know.

GAIL: Then I don't understand.

LYNETTE: Neither do I.

GAIL: So basically you're sitting here telling me for no good reason that you want to

LYNETTE: Not want. Need. Capital N. The big guns.

GAIL: Why?

LYNETTE: I don't know. An overwhelming biological necessity for alternate body types. I don't know.

GAIL: I don't think this is the place we should be discussing this.

LYNETTE: This is exactly the place. You are exactly the person. Gail. If I don't sleep with someone other than my husband very soon, I won't be responsible for myself.

GAIL: Lynette.

LYNETTE: Time bomb. Tick tick tick.

GAIL: Don't you think you're being a little overdramatic?

LYNETTE: No. Tick.

GAIL: Have you met someone?

LYNETTE: No. Although when you get right down to it, everybody's a candidate.

GAIL: You're kidding, right? All right, joke's over, very funny, ha ha, you're kidding.

LYNETTE: Gail, you don't know what it's like. I can't work. I can't sleep. Yesterday I looked at a clock. I forgot how to tell time. I'm losing my mind.

GAIL: You certainly are. Richard

LYNETTE: Is sweet and kind and good, I know. He adapts, no matter how crazy I am. "You're right honey, I'll be more careful, I'll try not to let my heels touch the floor in that irritating

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

manner anymore." I could tell him I want to chuck it all for a sugar cane farm in Borneo and he'd be researching farming techniques and plane fares within the hour.

GAIL: So it seems to me you have nothing to complain about.

LYNETTE: I'm not complaining. But God, if I don't find someone to sear me to the bones I am going to explode. Little pieces of me flying out my office window and over New York, settling on some old ladies in the park. Explode.

GAIL: I don't know what to say. You've put me in a difficult position. I love Richard.

LYNETTE: I do too.

GAIL: He and George are best friends.

LYNETTE: Like brothers.

GAIL: And you're my best friend

LYNETTE: *(expectantly)* Yes?

GAIL: Yes what?

LYNETTE: I'm your best friend. You'd do anything for me.

GAIL: Of course I would, you know that. What are you driving at?

LYNETTE: Sleep with me.

GAIL: What?! You can't be serious.

LYNETTE: I couldn't live with myself if I did it with another man, not to mention what it would do to Richard if he found out. But you

GAIL: Are astonished.

LYNETTE: You're a woman, Gail. It wouldn't be cheating. It would be experimenting.

GAIL: You're out of your mind.

LYNETTE: Will you do it?

GAIL: Of course not.

LYNETTE: Why not?

GAIL: In the first place, no offense, but I'm not physically attracted to you.

LYNETTE: Liar.

GAIL: What did you call me?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

LYNETTE: You're lying. You've wanted me from the day we met.

GAIL: Oh, now I agree with you, Lynette, you have gone over the deep end.

LYNETTE: You stare at me. You watch my mouth when I speak. When we kiss hello, you linger a little bit longer than necessary and you breathe in.

GAIL: I can't really have this conversation anymore, okay? Can we order? *(pause)* I think you should see a doctor.

LYNETTE: You're angry.

GAIL: I'm not, I'm flabbergasted. To think that after all these years of what I thought was a close friendship you would suddenly come up with this insane notion that I -- that we -- I'm married, Lynette.

LYNETTE: I know.

GAIL: And I love George. Not to mention I'm one hundred percent heterosexual.

LYNETTE: I'm going out of my mind.

GAIL: I wish I could help you. I really do.

LYNETTE: You love me.

GAIL: Of course I do. But that doesn't mean I desire you in a sexual manner.

LYNETTE: What about New Year's Eve?

GAIL: *(after a pause)* What about it?

LYNETTE: New Year's Eve, 1991. The four of us spent it together. I drank too many peach margaritas.

GAIL: I remember. You were so sick. Richard was so angry.

LYNETTE: I thought I'd never stop throwing up. When I finally did, I laid down on the bathroom floor, closed my eyes, and you kissed me. On the mouth.

GAIL: You must have dreamt it, Lynette, I think I would remember.

LYNETTE: I remember thinking, "how soft her mouth is."

GAIL: I did not kiss you, Lynette. I mean, I may have given you a peck on the cheek because I felt sorry for you, but beyond that, you are mistaken.

LYNETTE: Why are you so against this? You have me, I have my fling -- everybody wins.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

GAIL: Except Richard, and George.

LYNETTE: We don't tell them. This is a secret between friends. Inviolable.

GAIL: It's not that simple.

LYNETTE: Why not?

GAIL: Lynette, look -- do you want me to fix you up with someone? There are a lot of lesbians in the music business.

LYNETTE: I want you. Youre my friend, I can trust you, there's no danger of falling in love. I was going to say you're honest, but you can't even admit to kissing me when we both know . . .

GAIL: All right, all right, I kissed you, I kissed you! *(helplessly)* You looked so pretty. Lying. there with your hair spread out over the mat. So vulnerable and so . . . beautiful, actually.

LYNETTE: Sleep with me, Gail.

GAIL: I can't.

LYNETTE: Why not?

GAIL: Because I'm in love with you.

LYNETTE: What?

GAIL: I'm in love with you, Lynette. You think I go around kissing drunken smelly women on the mouth because it's a thing of mine?

LYNETTE: But I thought

GAIL: That my heart couldn't possibly leap every time I see you? That I don't feel profound jealousy when you and Richard reach for each other like any other happily married couple? That my feelings can't be real?

LYNETTE: No, I mean. . .

GAIL: What, Lynette? What did you think?

LYNETTE: I don't know. A harmless crush. Like schoolgirls.

GAIL: Not exactly.

LYNETTE: No. *(pause)* So where does this leave us?

GAIL: I don't know.

LYNETTE: *(after a pause)* Maybe I do drink too much.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

GAIL: Maybe.

LYNETTE: I have a problem.

GAIL: Yes.

LYNETTE: And you have a problem.

GAIL: Yes.

LYNETTE: What do you think we should do?

GAIL: I think we should order. *(They return to looking at their menus)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Cathy Celesia
Book: Take Ten: New 10-Min Plays, edited by Eric Lane and Nina Shingold, Pgs 13-20
ISBN: 978-0679772828
Publisher: Vintage Books
Date (Month/Year): March 1997

AWARD HISTORY

2001 National Qualifier
IL State Qualifier
IN State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY